

Pour into the students **, one build at a time.**

Microsoft already invests in young Jamaicans who want to build with technology. Hack876 is one day where high-school students get to do exactly that, with Microsoft people in the room.

Kingston, Jamaica • Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

80

STUDENTS

9

SCHOOL NETWORK

1

DAY



ONE DAY TO BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Young Jamaicans, real skills, real builds.

Hack876 reaches students a few years before university, and a Microsoft award would tell them their first build counts.

MICROSOFT, ABOUT

"Microsoft's mission is to empower every person and every organization on the planet to achieve more."²

Microsoft piloted Project Blue Mountain in 2024 to help make Jamaica the premier hub for STEAM talent development in the Caribbean, reaching secondary and tertiary institutions.³

Shane Patterson on leading it: "Coming back home and being able to pour into the students the way I would've wanted for myself is priceless."⁴

Tech Wave 2025 was set to open to high-school students for the first time, alongside university teams, with more than 30 teams mentored by technical experts.⁴

In 2021 Microsoft Jamaica and the Ministry of Education agreed a five-year plan to train 155,000 Jamaicans in digital skills, with a focus on young audiences.⁵

Through Microsoft Elevate, Microsoft has pledged more than \$4 billion in cash and AI and cloud technology to K-12 schools, colleges and nonprofits over five years.⁶

Five years of building talent at home.

2021

A national skills agreement.

Microsoft Jamaica and the Ministry of Education sign a five-year agreement to train 155,000 Jamaicans in digital skills.⁵

2022

Microsoft Day begins.

Microsoft Day starts at the University of Technology, Jamaica.⁷

2024

Project Blue Mountain is piloted.

Launched at the third Microsoft Day. Student teams pitch solutions to sustainable-development challenges in the PBM Hackathon finale.³

2025

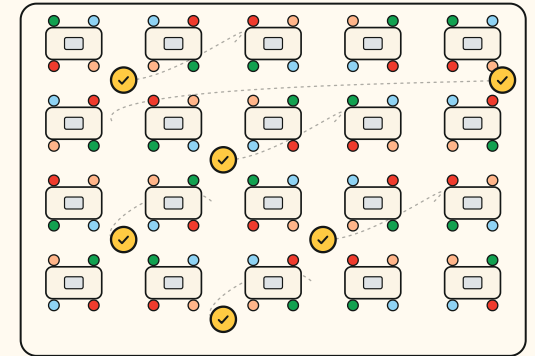
AI reaches Grades 8 to 11.

A week-long AI and entrepreneurship bootcamp at UWI Mona, run with AIM Educational Services in collaboration with Project Blue Mountain.⁸

2025

High schoolers invited in.

Tech Wave, powered by Microsoft, expands to include high-school students, with a three-place cash podium for the hackathon.⁴



Microsoft keeps reaching younger students in Jamaica. Hack876 is a natural next step: a build day for fifth and sixth formers.

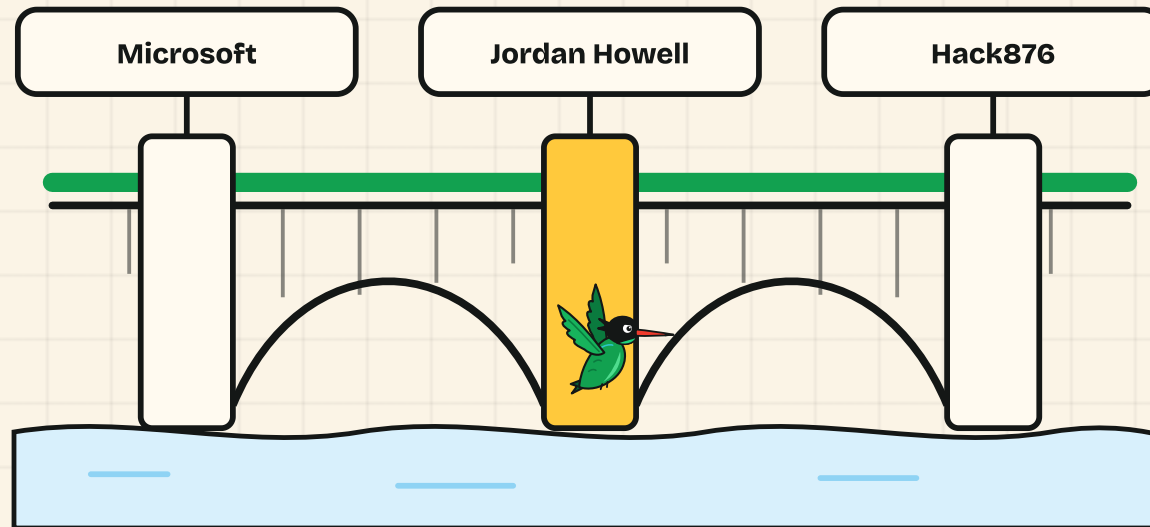
9 schools. One room.

Our judge Jordan Howell, who works at Microsoft, is a Champion College alumnus. Champion is in the Hack876 school network; its participation is not yet confirmed.

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

Hillel Academy	Campion College
Jamaica College	Immaculate Conception High School
Wolmer's	Ardenne High School
American International School of Kingston	St. Andrew High School for Girls
St. George's College	

Partnerships work better when someone carries the context.



Jordan is a confirmed Hack876 judge who works at Microsoft.

Jordan is also a Campion College alumnus, one of the schools in our network.

If open to it, Jordan could be a friendly first point of contact on the Microsoft side.

Because Jordan judges, any Microsoft-funded award would be decided by a judge who does not work at Microsoft.

THE BRIDGE

Jordan Howell

Hack876 judge · Microsoft

An invitation, not an obligation.

There are two natural homes for this inside Microsoft.

PRIZE

A Microsoft-backed podium

- ✓ Fund the podium prizes, or a proposed Microsoft award
- ✓ Presented on stage by the Microsoft team
- ✓ Open to any tools, so the best build wins
- ✓ Decided by a judge who does not work at Microsoft

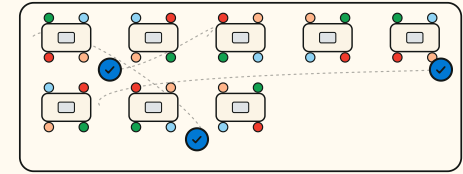
PEOPLE

Microsoft people in the room

- ✓ Three to five mentors for AI, cloud and data
- ✓ A short talk on building a tech career from Jamaica
- ✓ Remote mentoring works too

Microsoft's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

PEOPLE IN THE ROOM.



01

Mentors

Engineers who help teams get unstuck, without building the project for them.

02

Award presenters

The Microsoft team presents its award on stage at the close.

03

Speaker

A short, honest talk on coming home to build and give back.

04

Workshop lead

A short AI fundamentals session before the day, open to every team.

05

Judge

Jordan already judges. Microsoft-funded awards go to a judge outside Microsoft.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing, product sign-ups or account creation pushed to students, before, during or after the day.

No collection of student contact details or data by sponsors. Photos and names only with school and parent consent.

A judge who does not work at Microsoft decides any Microsoft-funded award, and teams may use any tools they choose.

Become an Official Prize Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

~US\$3,500

OFFICIAL PRIZE PARTNER • INAUGURAL HACK876

Microsoft already funds student hackathon prizes in Jamaica. Backing the Hack876 podium extends that to students a few years younger.

What it covers:

- ✓ Hack 876 Winner: iPad per student (up to 4)
- ✓ Second Place: AirPods Pro per student (up to 4)
- ✓ Third Place: US\$150 gift card per student (up to 4)

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

Microsoft

Official Prize Partner • Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Resilience, Learn, Business, Life

Choose the level that fits.

Official Prize Partner

~US\$3,500

OUR SUGGESTION FOR MICROSOFT

Hack 876 Winner	iPad per student (up to 4)	Approximately US\$1,800
Second Place	AirPods Pro per student (up to 4)	Approximately US\$1,000
Third Place	US\$150 gift card per student (up to 4)	US\$600

Special Awards Partner

US\$600

OUR SUGGESTION FOR MICROSOFT

Best Design, Boldest Idea, People's Choice: US\$600 for all 3, or US\$200 for one, presented by Microsoft.

Food & Student Experience Partner

US\$1,000

Approximately J\$150,000 for meals and refreshments, in cash or in kind.

In-kind / People Partner

TIME AND EXPERTISE

Microsoft mentors for AI, cloud and data, in person or remote, a short pre-event AI fundamentals session for teams, cloud credits held by organisers to host team demos, with no student accounts required, a speaker from Microsoft in Jamaica.

AN IDEA, NOT YET A HACK876 AWARD

Microsoft AI for Good Award (proposed)

A suggestion only: an award for the build that best uses technology to solve a real problem for a Jamaican community. Teams could use any tools, and criteria would be agreed together.

Costs are approximate. Final prize configuration may change with team structure, pricing and availability.

Every option at a glance.

OFFICIAL PRIZE PARTNER

~US\$3,500

INAUGURAL HACK876

Microsoft already funds student hackathon prizes in Jamaica. Backing the Hack876 podium extends that to students a few years younger.

SPECIAL AWARDS PARTNER

All 3 special awards, or US\$200 for one.

US\$600

FOOD & STUDENT EXPERIENCE PARTNER

Approximately J\$150,000 for meals and refreshments, in cash or in kind.

US\$1,000

IN-KIND / PEOPLE PARTNER

Judges, mentors, speakers, volunteers and resources.

Time

MICROSOFT AI FOR GOOD AWARD (PROPOSED)

A custom award shaped together.

Proposed

The size of the commitment can change. The invitation to be part of the first one does not.

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Shane Patterson, Principal Technical Program Manager, Microsoft, and Executive Director, Project Blue Mountain.**¹

If Microsoft is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ How is this different from the Project Blue Mountain hackathon?
- ✓ What exactly would our contribution pay for, and where would Microsoft's name appear?
- ✓ Can students use Azure or Copilot on the day, given their ages?
- ✓ How do you keep judging fair when one judge works at Microsoft?
- ✓ How are students protected on consent, data and marketing?
- ✓ How much time would our mentors need to give?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.

Learn from it.

**Earn the right to make
the second one bigger.**

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

A recurring Microsoft award at every Hack876.

Hack876 finalists invited to a future Tech Wave, if the Project Blue Mountain team would welcome them.

A Microsoft mentor bench each year, growing as more alumni join.

Support for network schools exploring Microsoft's education tools with their own IT teams.

A pathway into Microsoft's university-level skills programmes once students leave school.



HACK876 x MICROSOFT

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore the right first step with Shane, Yamile and the Microsoft team in
Jamaica.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

hack876.com

SOURCES

1. LinkedIn, "Shane Patterson: Tech Wave 2025 post (shares a UTech note listing his titles):" www.linkedin.com/posts/shane-patterson-56316925_techwave-caribbeantalent-globalimpact-activity-7387955450841018369-Q4Xq
2. Microsoft, "About Microsoft (mission)," www.microsoft.com/en-us/about
3. Canada Caribbean Institute, "NCU students showcase waste management app (October 27, 2024)," canadacaribbeaninstitute.org/2024/10/27/ncu-students-showcase-waste-management-app/
4. Jamaica Observer, "Project Blue Mountain's Tech Wave Conference set to stir talent, drive innovation (October 22, 2025)," www.jamaicaobserver.com/2025/10/22/project-blue-mountains-tech-wave-conference-set-stir-talent-drive-innovation/
5. Microsoft News Center, "MoEYI and Microsoft Jamaica target 155,000 persons for employability in new skills training agreement (July 30, 2021)," news.microsoft.com/es-xl/moe-yi-and-microsoft-jamaica-target-155000-persons-for-employability-in-new-skills-training-agreement/
6. Microsoft On the Issues, "Microsoft Elevate: Putting people first, Brad Smith (July 9, 2025)," blogs.microsoft.com/on-the-issues/2025/07/09/elevate/
7. Jamaica Gleaner, "UTech to host Microsoft Day 2024 (October 1, 2024)," past.jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20241001/utech-host-microsoft-day-2024
8. Jamaica Observer, "AIM Educational Services and Microsoft empower youth with AI bootcamp (July 24, 2025)," www.jamaicaobserver.com/2025/07/24/aim-educational-services-microsoft-empower-youth-ai-bootcamp/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Shane Patterson, Principal Technical Program Manager, Microsoft, and Executive Director, Project Blue Mountain, with Yamile Bustamante, Country Representative, Microsoft Jamaica.